

Japan Technology: Hardware – Industrial Electronics: GEV 2Q read-across: Strong power grid demand positive for Hitachi Energy

GE Vernova (covered by US Multi-Industry sector analyst Joe Ritchie) announced its 2Q FY26 results ([LINK](#)) on July 22. **2Q sales in the Electrification business, which handles power grid products, came to \$3,637 mn (FactSet consensus: \$3,437 mn), and EBITDA was \$671 mn (consensus: \$630 mn), both exceeding expectations. 2Q orders for the business were \$6,347 mn, up 93% yoy. GEV raised its full-year guidance for the business, lifting its sales outlook to \$14.5–\$15.0 bn from \$14.0–\$14.5 bn (including revised Prolec GE guidance of \$3.1 bn, up from \$3.0 bn); EBITDA margin guidance was maintained at 18–20%.**

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The results confirmed that the demand environment for power grid products such as transformers and switchgear remains strong. Data center-related orders in 1H FY26 exceeded \$5 bn, already surpassing the full-year FY25 level, which suggests that in addition to conventional infrastructure upgrade demand, data center demand is also growing strongly. According to GEV, some shipments of solid state transformers (SSTs) to hyperscalers will also begin in the second half of this year, which could lead to increased demand for 800VDC-related products going forward. The confirmation of a strong demand environment has positive implications for Hitachi Energy, which operates a similar business. Hitachi's 1Q results are scheduled for release on July 29.

Key points from the GE Vernova results briefing

Commentary below refers to the Electrification business.

- 2Q sales came to \$3,637 mn (FactSet consensus: \$3,437 mn), for organic growth of +29% yoy.
- 2Q EBITDA was \$671 mn (consensus: \$630 mn), and the EBITDA margin was 18.4% (+390 bps yoy).
- 2Q orders were \$6,347 mn, for organic growth of +66% yoy.
- The order backlog was \$44.6 bn, up +65% yoy.
- Demand was strong for grid equipment such as substations, switchgear, and transformers, with 2Q orders at roughly 1.7x sales.
- Strong demand for switchgear, substations, transformers, and HVDC equipment drove sales growth.
- EBITDA margins trended higher on increased volume, productivity gains, and price improvements.

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- The company booked \$2.7 bn in data center-related orders in 2Q alone and over \$5 bn for 1H FY26, surpassing the full-year FY25 level.
- GEV commented that this \$5 bn in orders includes Solid State Transformers (SSTs), and that shipments of 5MW indoor SST prototypes to hyperscalers will begin in 2H of this year. It also said it is developing a 6MW outdoor SST.
- Development of MV UPS is also underway, and the company expects to book orders for these sooner than for SSTs. It is targeting order wins from 2H26 to 2027.
- The company won \$800 mn in transformer orders for the US market in 1H FY26. It said this reflects the benefits of establishing a global production system through the acquisition of Prolec GE.
- GEV raised its full-year FY26 guidance. Sales guidance was lifted to \$14.5-\$15.0 bn (from \$14.0-\$14.5 bn), including Prolec GE guidance of \$3.1 bn (up from \$3.0 bn). EBITDA margin guidance was maintained at 18-20%.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Hitachi

We are Buy rated. Our 12-month target price of ¥6,300 for Hitachi is based on an EV/EBITDA multiple of 13X (base year is FY3/28E; the multiple is based on the EV/EBITDA and EBITDA margin correlation across its domestic and global competitors).

Risks: **Digital systems & services:** delays and losses on large projects, weaker IT capex sentiment at customers accompanying a macroeconomic downturn, reemergence of supply disruptions for servers and other products, slower standalone growth at GlobalLogic, slower-than-expected realization of synergies between Hitachi and GlobalLogic; **Energy (Power grid):** delays on power transmission/distribution projects, a sharp rise in input costs; **Connective industries:** weaker new construction demand in China, losing out on new repair/maintenance orders to competitors in Japan, semiconductor production equipment (SPE) prices not improving over the long term a risk for the measurement and analysis systems business (Hitachi High-Tech);

Companywide: Forex swings (¥1 appreciation vs. USD likely has a negative impact of ¥7 bn on sales and ¥0.8 bn on adjusted EBITA) and an increase in purchase price allocation (PPA) amortization due to forex swings.

Disclosure Appendix

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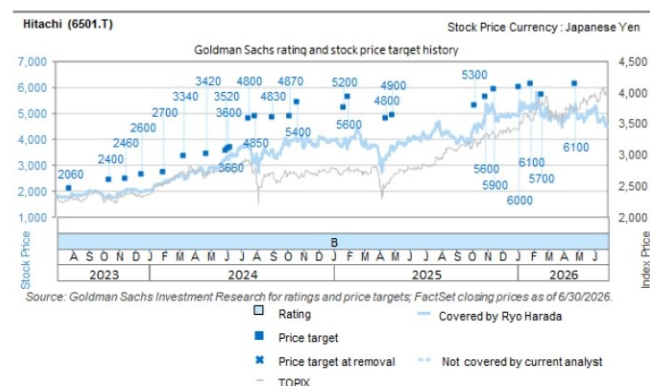
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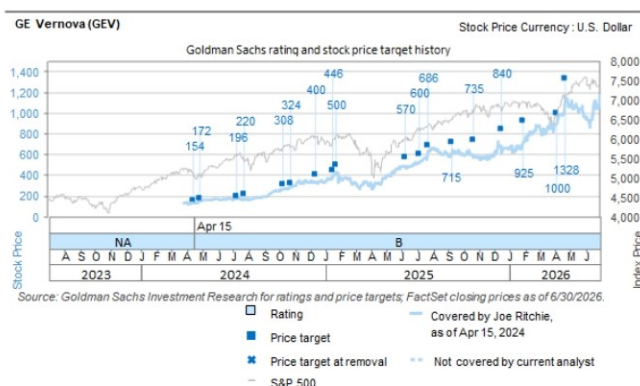
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Target price history table(s)

GE Vernova (GEV)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
10-Jul-26	1,289.00	1,091.57
24-Apr-26	1,328.00	1,149.19
06-Apr-26	1,000.00	897.36
28-Jan-26	925.00	711.59
16-Dec-25	840.00	686.22
22-Oct-25	735.00	576.00
08-Sep-25	715.00	600.23
23-Jul-25	686.00	629.03
07-Jul-25	600.00	530.28
09-Jun-25	570.00	480.00
23-Jan-25	500.00	437.71
16-Jan-25	446.00	391.00
12-Dec-24	400.00	329.91
24-Oct-24	324.00	297.00
09-Oct-24	308.00	266.60
26-Jul-24	220.00	173.11
10-Jul-24	196.00	179.73
29-Apr-24	172.00	159.01
16-Apr-24	154.00	130.07

Hitachi (6501.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
07-Jul-26	6,300	4,942
27-Apr-26	6,100	5,356
19-Feb-26	5,700	4,992
29-Jan-26	6,100	5,077
05-Jan-26	6,000	5,068
17-Nov-25	5,900	5,122
30-Oct-25	5,600	4,963
08-Oct-25	5,300	4,477
28-Apr-25	4,900	3,747
16-Apr-25	4,800	3,260
31-Jan-25	5,600	3,946
22-Jan-25	5,200	3,929
23-Oct-24	5,400	3,896
07-Oct-24	4,870	3,904
02-Sep-24	4,830	3,603
31-Jul-24	4,850	3,288
18-Jul-24	4,800	3,663
11-Jun-24	18,300	3,412
07-Jun-24	18,000	3,270
03-Jun-24	17,600	3,313
26-Apr-24	17,100	2,695
12-Mar-24	16,700	2,467
31-Jan-24	13,500	2,335
19-Dec-23	13,000	1,988
16-Nov-23	12,300	2,009
16-Oct-23	12,000	1,806
28-Jul-23	10,300	1,742

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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